



Image Courtesy: THE RAVI SHANKAR CENTRE, NEW DELHI

MUSIC

MUSIC MAKES A COMEBACK

The **Ravi Shankar International Festival of Arts** is bringing the joy of live music back to the capital

Speaking to us from London, Sukanya Shankar sounds both relieved and joyous. After over two years, the Ravi Shankar Centre in Delhi will again be opening its doors and hosting a live event. "You might have a million people watching on Zoom, but it's still a machine. What is missing is that vibration you get from human beings sitting in a room, listening and responding to music," she says. For all its faults and tragedies, Covid, Shankar believes, has taught us just "how precious a live concert can be".

As founding trustee, Sukanya Shankar

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Labour of Love

Sarod players Amaan and Ayaan Ali Bangash hope their new EP will usher in social awareness



Wanting to initiate a public conversation about child sexual abuse, brothers and sarod players Amaan and Ayaan Ali Bangash recently released their EP, *We for Love*. Their music, they hope, will raise awareness about children's rights activist Kailash Satyarthi's 'Justice for Every Child' initiative, a campaign that focuses on providing legal and mental health support to children who have been victims of rape and sexual abuse. "This project has been life-changing for me, both as a musician and as a human being. Now, as a parent, I have become even more passionate about this cause," says Ayaan, the younger of the two brothers.

Their association with Satyarthi began in 2014, in Oslo, Norway, when the noted social reformer, along with Malala Yousafzai, received the Nobel Peace Prize. The brothers were there, performing at the ceremony with their father, renowned sarod player Ustad Amjad Ali Khan, who they managed to rope in for a track on the EP. 'Gandhi's Hymn' is a poignant, beautiful piece that closes the six-track EP.

For the other five tracks, they collaborated with a wide array of musicians—Karsh Kale, Malini Awasthi, Mahesh Kale and Shubha Mudgal. Even Karan Johar makes an